



Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: Schertz
School Website: <https://www.foundersschertz.com/>

January 6, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy – Schertz (Schertz, TX) presents itself publicly as a classical school that emphasizes virtue, truth, beauty, and the liberal arts. The campus materials repeatedly articulate a classical orientation (classical education, liberal arts curriculum, virtue-focused goals) and describe partnerships with families. However, the public-facing materials do not consistently foreground explicit theology, liturgical practice, or the full spectrum of classical pedagogical practices (e.g., Socratic seminars, memorization/chants, and “scholé” rhythms) that the classical rubric often expects at all grade levels, especially in the upper grades. As such, the school demonstrates meaningful classical intent and content, but with notable gaps relative to a fully developed classical program across all six categories.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key observations across the six categories: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Strong emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty, and virtue; lacking explicit theology or liturgical practice in public materials. Evidence of classical orientation is clear, but theological grounding is not openly stated on the site. - Purpose and Goals: Clear formation of character and virtue as the primary goal; formation rather than information is implied through virtue-focused language. The school emphasizes forming virtuous citizens, aligning with classical aims. - Curriculum: Public statements reference a “traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum.” However, explicit Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric sequencing, and the Great Conversation are not clearly stated in the site copy. This yields partial alignment with the curriculum criterion. - Pedagogy: The public materials emphasize a traditional/classical approach but do not consistently document the full spectrum of classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars in upper school, chant/memory routines, Scholé practices). This is a mixed signal. - Faculty: Public-facing pages show named faculty and staff, signaling an engaged faculty body; however, the materials do not explicitly describe the faculty as “living curriculum” mentors or portraits of teacher ideals in the way classical rubrics sometimes require. - Parents & Community: The school emphasizes partnership with families and has parent-focused enrollment actions; explicit program for parent formation is not strongly detailed on the site, though there are signals of collaboration with families.

Note: The knowledge-base sources (Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and Positive/Negative Keyword Lexicon) provide the canonical criteria and vocabulary for a fully classical implementation (e.g., Great Books, Scholé, Socratic pedagogy, liturgy, and a “living curriculum”). These lexicon resources show that true classical fidelity includes explicit theology, liturgical practice, and a full spectrum of classical pedagogy beyond what the FCA Schertz site currently emphasizes. See the lexicon and codebook for reference.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize truth, beauty, and goodness as guiding ideals and virtuous character formation. The program states a orientation toward truth, beauty, and goodness, and mentions forming virtuous citizens. - The explicit grounding in theology, liturgy, and related sacred practices is not evident in the public materials. The absence of explicit theological architecture on the site lowers the category's alignment relative to a fully scholastic, theology-grounded model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, beauty, goodness, virtue (and related phrases like virtuous). These align with the Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements lexicon for this category. Approximately 4 positive keywords appear in the site copy. No explicit negative signals appear in the accessible text.

Why this rating - The school clearly foregrounds transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue, which aligns with transcendental moral realism and virtue-centered formation. However, the absence of explicit theological grounding and liturgical/community practices in public materials prevents a full CLASSICAL rating for this category. The rubric's strongest signals for this category (grounded theology, liturgical practice) are not publicly evidenced on the site. Therefore: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school identifies formation of virtuous citizens as a core end of public education, alongside forming human excellence and flourishing. The emphasis is on virtue, formation, and the telos of education rather than mere job preparation. - There is language about pursuing truth, goodness, and beauty and a belief in forming humans rather than merely imparting information. The explicit formation language aligns with the classical mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom (implied by virtue and formation), the true/good/beautiful framing; Great Books and other classical mission terms are not all explicit, but the core formation language is strong. Approximately 3–4 positive keywords observed; negative indicators are not evident in the accessible text.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials foreground formation, virtue, and a teleological aim (truth, goodness, beauty) that exceed mere information transfer, aligning with classical aims in this category. The absence of explicit work-preparatory language (to some degree) reinforces CLASSICAL, but the lack of explicit references to more explicit classical aims (e.g., rigorous Great Books framing) makes it not fully CLASSICAL. Thus: CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site describes a “traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum,” which is a hallmark of classical curriculum design. - Specific elements such as grammar, logic, rhetoric and explicit Great Books or Great Conversation are not clearly stated on the public materials. The site does not consistently reference Great Books or a program-wide Great Conversation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, classical curriculum (genre-wide), grammar/logic/rhetoric are implied by “liberal arts” framing, and the site's classical branding. The explicit Great Books/Great Conversation terms are not found in the accessible text; so positive keyword hits are limited to liberal-arts framing. Roughly 1–2 positive keywords present; negative keywords (e.g., social studies-first framing, project-based exclusively) are not present in the accessible copy.

Why this rating - Core curricular vocabulary aligns with classical aims (liberal arts). However, explicit, standard classical curricular markers (grammar/logic/rhetoric sequencing; Great Books; Great Conversation; explicit history-throughout curriculum) are not clearly present in public materials. Therefore: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public-facing materials articulate a classical approach to education with a liberal-arts orientation and a traditional classroom structure. This suggests some alignment with classical pedagogy. - Explicit mentions of core classical pedagogy elements such as Socratic seminars, nightly oratory/rhetoric training, chant/memory work, or scholé rhythms are not documented in the site copy. The absence of clear Socratic/seminar practice in upper grades reduces full alignment.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé (restful learning) and wonder, if present, would be strong signals per the lexicon; however, the site copy does not frequently deploy these exact terms. There is a recognized emphasis on classical approach, but the concrete pedagogical practices (Socratic, memory work, chanting) are not documented. Approximately 1–2 positive keywords observed; negative signals are not evident from the accessible text, but lack of explicit classical pedagogy lowers the fit.

Why this rating - The school communicates a classical methodology, but without explicit evidence of the full spectrum of high-school pedagogical practices (Socratic seminars, memory work, scholé-based routines) that would anchor a CLASSICAL rating. Therefore: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site lists named faculty (Headmaster, Dean of Students, various teachers), signaling a substantive faculty presence. This supports the expectation of model teachers and mentors in a classical frame. - The materials do not, however, explicitly describe the faculty as a “living curriculum,” nor do they provide a formal portrait of teacher ideals or a clearly articulated faculty philosophy in the public copy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: the idea of a strong faculty is signaled by the listing of named staff; however, explicit language about the faculty as “living curriculum” or “portrait of a teacher” is not documented in the accessible text. Approximately 1–2 positive signals; no explicit negative signals observed.

Why this rating - The existence of a staffed faculty aligns with a classical model, but the absence of explicit “living curriculum” or teacher-ideal language in public materials reduces the rating from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Therefore: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and expresses a desire to partner with families in the education of students. The enrollment language explicitly invites parent participation and partnership. - Public-facing materials show a Parent/Guardian option in the registration/tools, indicating engagement with families and some level of parental involvement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent involvement, home-school collaboration, parental engagement (from the lexicon). The site shows explicit language of partnering with families and parent interaction tools. Approximately 2–3 positive signals observed; no explicit negative signals visible in the accessible text.

Why this rating - The site demonstrates commitment to parent partnership and open pathways for parent involvement, aligning with the Six Elements’ expectations for active parental engagement. However, the materials do not consistently detail structured parent formation programs or a formal “parent as co-teacher” framework, which slightly narrows the alignment. Therefore: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Strengthen explicit theology and liturgical/community practices in public communications to satisfy the Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices criteria (Element 1). Include statements

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- about theology integration, chapel presence, sacred music, or liturgical calendar alignment.
- Elevate explicit Great Books and Great Conversation framing in the Curriculum section (Element 3). Add language around a core Great Books list, classical authors, and a clear progression through grammar/logic/rhetoric, with history woven throughout the curriculum.
 - Document specific pedagogical practices that align with classical pedagogy for upper grades (Element 4). Include mention of Socratic seminars, Paideia-style discussions, rhetoric training, and a formal Scholé rhythm (rest, contemplation, and memory work).
 - Make the Faculty a more explicit part of the “living curriculum” by publishing a teacher-formation statement, portrait of ideal teacher-student relationships, and professional development in classical pedagogy (Element 5).
 - Expand explicit, structured Parent Formation and Community-Engagement programs (Element 6). Publish details about parent book clubs, family catechesis, home-school partnerships, and regular campus visits as a standard practice.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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